

May
21



1871 Up the mountain

Europe's first mountain railway opened in Switzerland. The Vitznau–Rigi Railway climbs Mount Rigi from Vitznau on the shore of Lake Lucerne. It was the brainchild of Swiss engineer Niklaus Rigggenbach, who wanted passengers to enjoy the breathtaking alpine views.

Also on this day

1792 The eruption of Mount Unzen in Japan triggered an earthquake, a landslide, and a 100 m (330 ft) tall tsunami.

1904 The Fédération Internationale de Football Association (FIFA), the highest governing body for the sport of football, was founded in Paris, France, by seven European nations.

2010 The first spacecraft powered by solar radiation, IKAROS was launched by Japanese space agency JAXA.

Console unwrapped

US software corporation Microsoft unveiled its Xbox One console, which could be used to play games or watch TV shows and films. More than 48 million consoles were sold in the seven years following its launch.



Born this day

1994 Tom Daley, British diver. He has won 10 gold medals at Commonwealth, European, and World championships.

1932 Earhart's flight

The first woman and second person to fly solo across the Atlantic Ocean, US aviator Amelia Earhart took off from Newfoundland, Canada, and landed 15 hours later in Londonderry, Northern Ireland.

